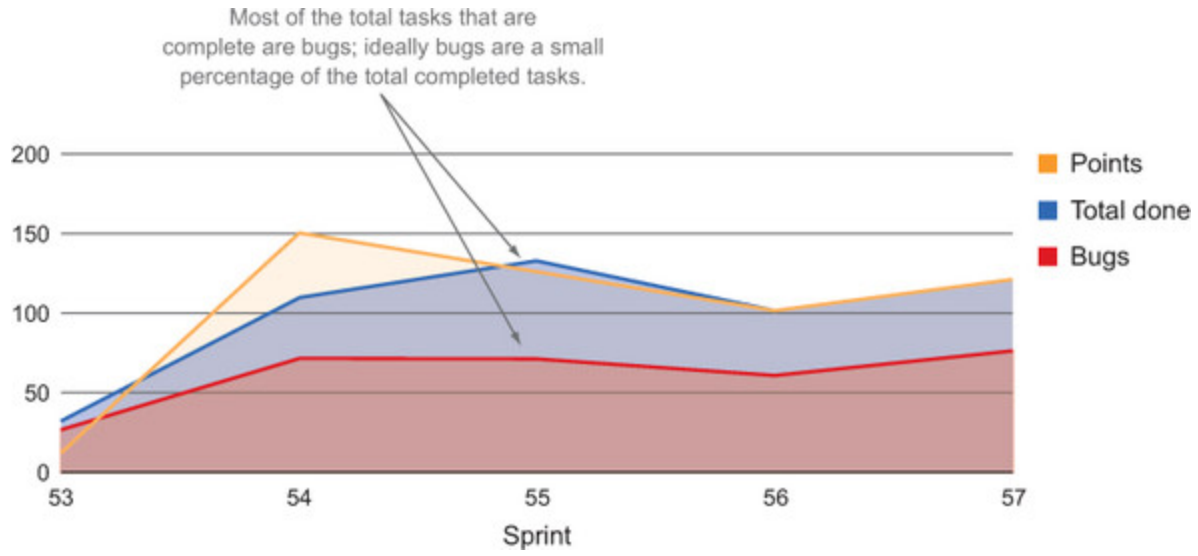
Whoa! That doesn’t look right at all! Volume and estimates are mostly parallel, but according to this we’re getting the same amount of tasks completed as points. Because each task should have an estimate attached to it, points should be much higher than tasks. After a closer look at the data we noticed that a lot of bugs were also getting completed, so we added that to our chart (figure 3.19).

Figure 3.19. Adding bugs



At this point we were much closer to the full picture. The huge volume of bugs that we had to power through every sprint was causing volume to go way up, and because the team wasn’t estimating bugs we weren’t getting the number of estimated features done that we thought we could. We all discussed the problem, and in this case the development team pointed to the huge amount of tech debt that had been piling up over time. Most of the things we completed ended up having edge cases and race conditions that caused problems with the functionality of the product. To show the amount of work that was moving backward in sprint, we also started mapping that out, as shown in figure 3.20.

Figure 3.20. Adding tasks that move backward to the chart